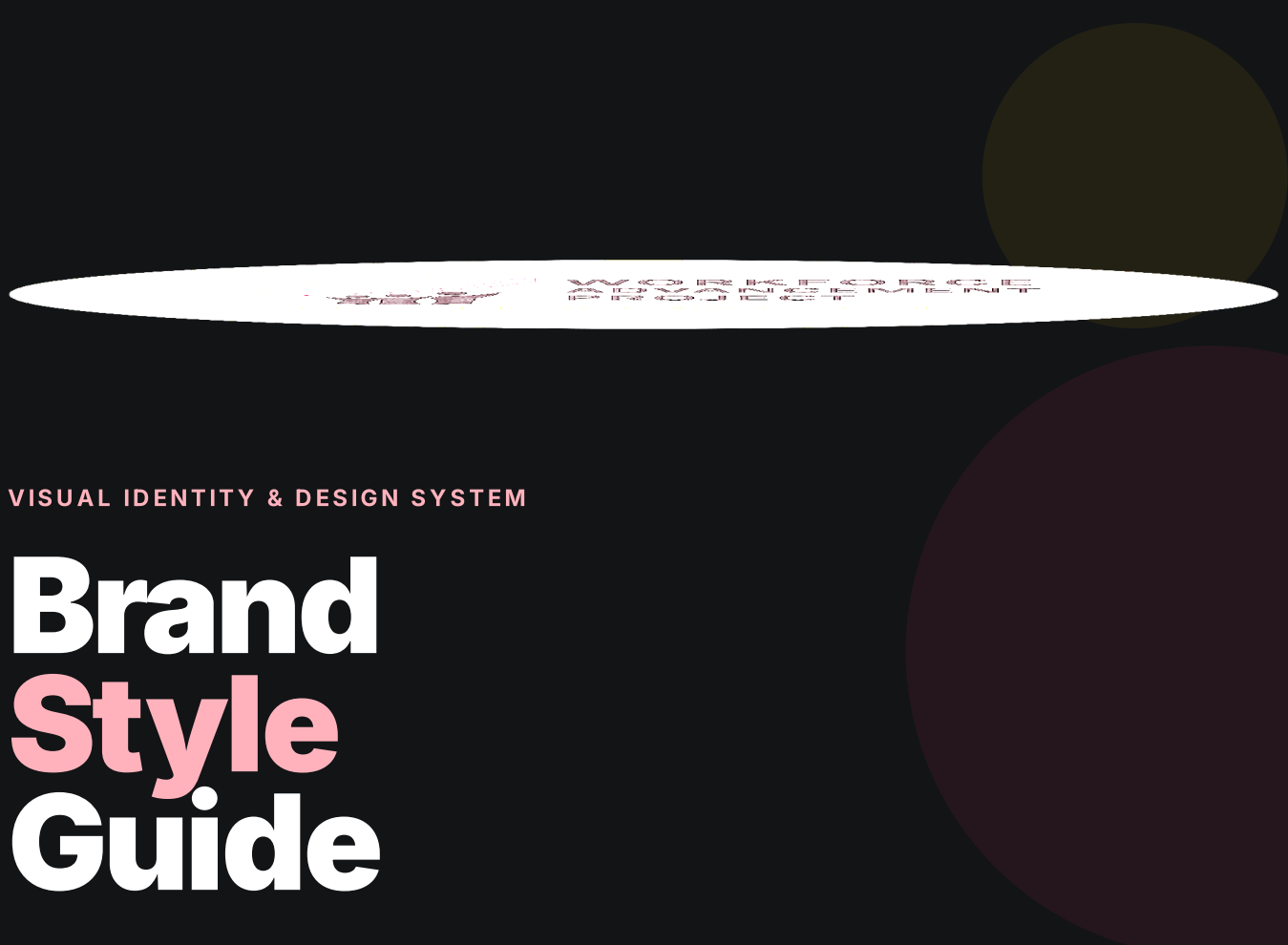




VISUAL IDENTITY & DESIGN SYSTEM

Brand Style Guide

Marketing Standards for WorkforceAP

Version 2.0 · March 2026 · Confidential

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This document defines visual and verbal standards for all WorkforceAP marketing materials — website, social media, printed collateral, presentations, and partner communications. When in doubt: use the color tokens, not hardcoded values. Use the typeface, not alternatives. Use the terminology list, not synonyms.

Who We Are

The mission, the model, and how we position against the market.

MISSION STATEMENT

Connecting underserved adults, the organizations that serve them, and the employers that need them — in one verified closed loop.

WorkforceAP is the operating system for workforce development. Free to members. Employer-aligned. Outcome-accountable.

Apply for Free

Partner With Us

BRAND PERSONALITY

Trait	Meaning
Grounded	We show outcomes, not promises.
Direct	Plain language. No corporate jargon.
Warm	This is someone's livelihood — handle with care.
Ambitious	We're building infrastructure, not a charity.
Inclusive	No age gate. No degree. No exclusion.

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT

We Are	We're Not
Free to all qualifying members	Employer-sponsored only
Adults 18+ at any career stage	Recent grads only
Verified placement + tracking	Certificate mill
Full-stack AI platform	PDF worksheets
180-day post-placement record	One-time boot camp

Palette

Built for WCAG AA compliance. Light and dark mode aware.

PRIMARY PALETTE



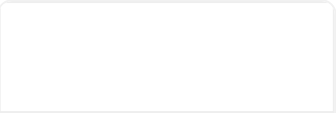
Crimson (Accent)
#AD2C4D
CTAs, links, accents, hero badges



Gold
#FFBB00
Dark backgrounds only — never on light



Near Black
#121416
Hero backgrounds, dark surfaces



White
#FFFFFF
Text on dark backgrounds, surfaces

SUPPORTING PALETTE



Accent Dark
#8B1F38
Hover state for Crimson



Blue
#2B7BB9
Links, informational states



Green
#4A9B4F
Success states, positive metrics



On Surface Var.
#584144
Secondary text, labels, captions

✓ **USE CRIMSON AS THE SOLE CTA COLOR**

One primary action per view. Always Crimson (#AD2C4D). Consistent. Trustworthy.

✗ **USE GOLD ON LIGHT BACKGROUNDS**

Gold on white = 1.7:1 contrast ratio. Fails WCAG. Use Gold on dark surfaces only.

✓ **USE CSS TOKENS IN CODE**

```
var(--color-accent) not #AD2C4D  
var(--color-gold) not #FFBB00
```

✗ **HARDCODE HEX VALUES IN NEW CODE**

Hardcoded colors break dark mode. Always use the CSS token system.

Type System

Inter is our single typeface. Hierarchy through weight and size — never font switching.

Display / H1

40px · 800 ·
-0.03em

Empowering People.

H2

32px · 700 ·
-0.02em

Industry-Recognized Certifications

H3

24px · 700 ·
-0.01em

Digital Literacy Program

H4

20px · 700 · 0

Program Requirements

Body

16px · 400 ·
1.6lh

WorkforceAP provides free career training to adults at every stage of their journey. Our programs are employer-aligned and outcome-accountable.

Small

14px · 400 ·
1.5lh

Program duration: 3–6 months · Cost to member: \$0 · CompTIA certified

Label Upper

10px · 700 ·
+0.1em

CURATED EXCELLENCE

LINE HEIGHT

Body: 1.6×
Headings: 1.0–1.2×
Labels: 1.2×

LETTER SPACING

Display: -0.03em
Labels: +0.06–0.15em
Body: 0

MEASURE

Body: 65–70 chars
Max width: ~680px
Headlines: unrestricted

Space & Grid

8px base grid. Consistent scale. No arbitrary values in new code.

SPACING SCALE

Token	Value	Usage
--space-1	4px	Icon gaps, tight badge padding
--space-2	8px	Compact element padding
--space-4	16px	Standard gap, button padding
--space-6	24px	Card padding, element gaps
--space-8	32px	Section element spacing
--space-12	48px	Mobile section padding
--space-16	64px	Desktop section padding
--space-24	96px	Hero and major section padding

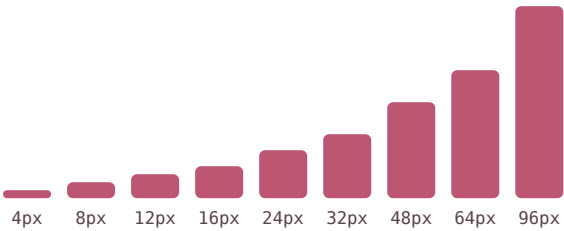
BORDER RADIUS

Token	Value	Usage
--radius-sm	4px	Tags, badges
--radius-md	8px	Buttons, inputs
--radius-lg	12px	Cards, dropdowns
--radius-xl	16px	Modals, prominent containers
--radius-full	50px	Pills, avatars, rounded badges

BREAKPOINTS

Name	Range
Mobile	<640px — single column, 44px touch targets
Tablet	640–1024px — two-column grid
Desktop	1024–1440px — full layout
Wide	>1440px — capped, centered

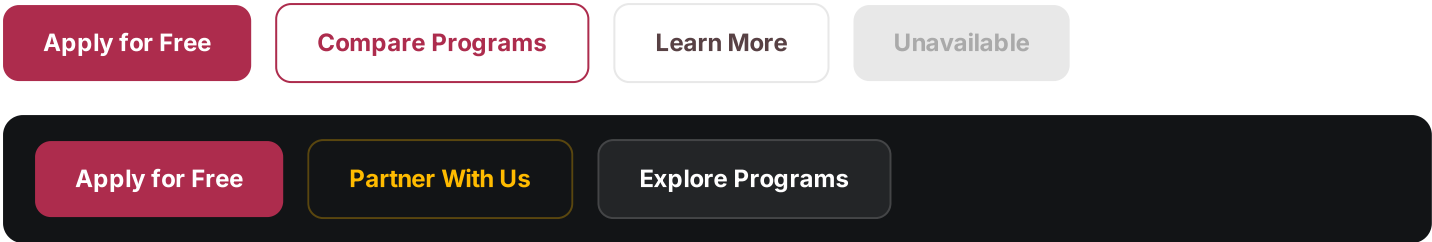
SPACING VISUALIZED



Interactive Elements

One primary action per view. Clear hierarchy. Specific copy.

BUTTON VARIANTS



BUTTON HIERARCHY RULES

Type	When to Use
Primary	One per screen. Main conversion (Apply, Start, Submit)
Secondary	Supporting actions (Learn More, Compare)
Ghost	Tertiary, nav items, destructive with care
Disabled	Unavailable — always add tooltip explaining why
Gold (dark bg)	Secondary CTA on dark hero sections only

CTA COPY RULES

✓ Write This	✗ Not This
Apply for Free	Learn More
Start My Application	Click Here
Compare Programs	Submit
Download Salary Guide	Get Started Today!
Partner With Us	Explore Opportunities

Containers & Elevation

Surfaces create hierarchy. Elevation through color, not drop shadows.

CARD VARIANTS

Default Card

White background, light border. For content sections on light pages.

Elevated Card

Surface-low background. Subtle shadow. For featured content.

Highlighted Card

Gold border on white. For featured programs or awards.

Accent Card

For primary CTAs, featured content blocks. One per section max.

Dark Card

For stat displays, testimonials, metrics on hero sections.

Gradient Card

Use sparingly. Max one gradient element per page section.

DARK MODE SURFACE SYSTEM

Surface Level	Token	Light Value	Dark Value	Usage
Page Background	--color-surface	#FAFAFA	#121416	Page root
Container Low	--surface-container-low	#F7F8FA	#1A1C1E	Cards, sidebars
Container	--surface-container	#F0F1F3	#1E2022	Elevated cards
Container High	--surface-container-high	#E8E9EB	#282A2C	Highest elevation

Logo Standards

Consistent. Never stretched. Never recolored. Always with clear space.



LOGO RULES

Rule	Standard
Clear Space	Min 1× height of "W" on all sides
Min Size	120px wide (digital) / 1 inch (print)
On Light	Full color (crimson wordmark)
On Dark	White version
On Accent	White version only

NEVER DO THIS

× Violation	Why It Matters
Stretch or skew	Destroys brand trust and recognition
Recolor or add gradient	Dilutes brand identity
Add drop shadow	Logo has no shadow in its design system
Place on busy photos	Must have plain or overlay background
Use below 120px	Letterforms become illegible

How WorkforceAP Sounds

Plain. Direct. Human. Specific. Never corporate speak.

✓ **DIRECT, NOT COLD**

"Apply now. We respond within 3–5 business days."

✗ **CORPORATE AND HOLLOW**

"We'd love to connect on your exciting journey forward!"

✓ **SPECIFIC AND REAL**

"CompTIA A+ certified. IBM AI Professional. \$62K–\$88K starting range."

✗ **VAGUE AND UNVERIFIABLE**

"Industry-recognized certifications in high-demand fields."

✓ **INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE**

"For adults at any stage of their career."

✗ **EXCLUSIVE LANGUAGE**

"For recent grads and young professionals entering the workforce."

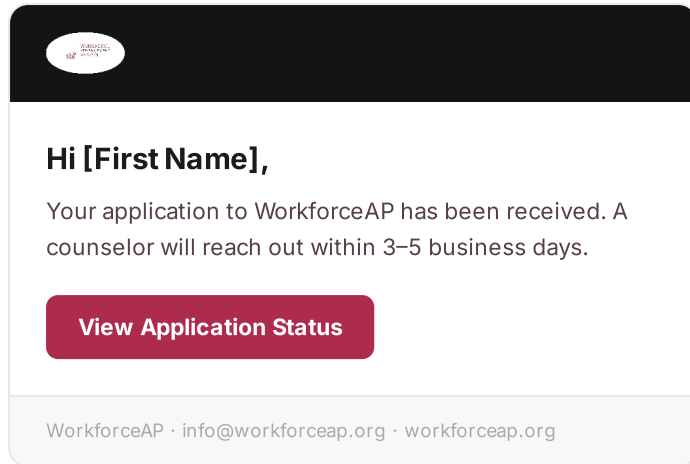
TERMINOLOGY STANDARDS

✓ Use This	✗ Not This	Reason
Member	Student, User, Candidate	We serve adults, not students. "Member" conveys community.
Counselor	Advisor, Coach, Mentor	Counselors have specific roles — keep it precise.
Partner	Affiliate, Vendor, Client	Referring organizations are valued collaborators.
Free / \$0	No-cost, Complimentary, Free*	Say it plainly. Asterisks create distrust.
WorkforceAP	WAP, Workforce AP, workforce ap	One word, camel case. Always.
CompTIA A+	"a certification", "A+ cert"	Always use the full official certification name.

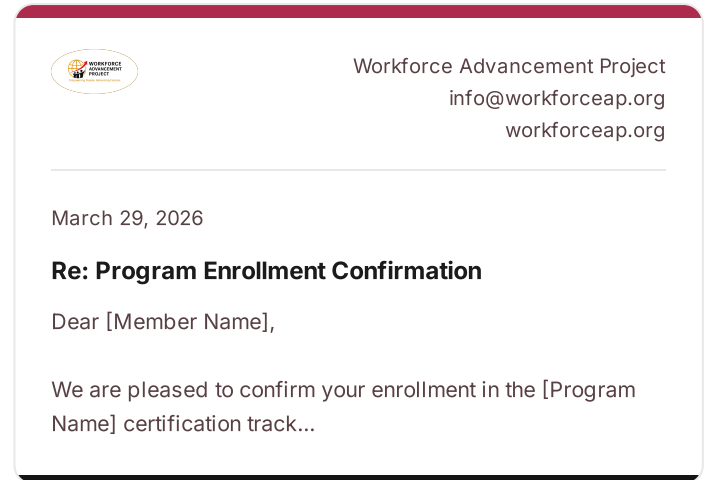
Branded Documents

Email, letterhead, and report headers — consistent across all communications.

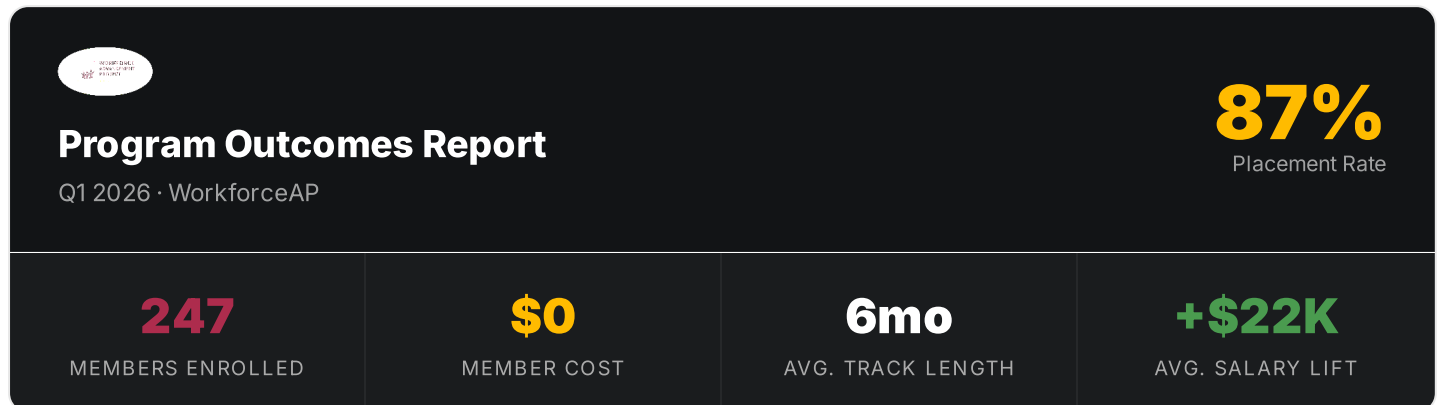
EMAIL HEADER TEMPLATE



LETTERHEAD TEMPLATE



REPORT HEADER TEMPLATE



All Rules. One Page.

Clip this page and pin it. These are the non-negotiables.

PRIMARY CTA COLOR

Crimson #AD2C4D — always. One per screen.

GOLD USAGE

Dark backgrounds only. Never on white or light gray (fails WCAG).

HERO TEXT

On dark overlays: use #fff directly, not var(--color-white).

FONT

Inter only. Body 16px/1.6. Headings Bold 700. No other faces.

SPACING

8px grid. Use CSS tokens — no arbitrary values in code.

CONTRAST

4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text (18px+), 3:1 UI components (WCAG AA).

BORDER RADIUS

Buttons: 8px. Cards: 12px. Modals: 16px. Never uniform everywhere.

MOBILE

<640px: single column, 44px touch targets, bottom nav.

LOGO CLEAR SPACE

1× "W" height on all sides. Never below 120px wide.

CTA COPY

Specific + active voice. "Apply for Free" > "Learn More".

DARK MODE CODE

Use var() tokens — never hardcode hex values in components.

TERMINOLOGY

"Member" not "student." "WorkforceAP" not "WAP." "Free" not "complimentary."

Questions about the brand?

The live design system lives in the repo under `css/main.css`.

